and the First Amendment guarantees the right to free speech.

Global leaders, particularly those from nations without close ties to the United States, defended Snowden. Nicolás Maduro, president of Venezuela, told a reporter, "How many missiles has Snowden launched against innocent peoples around the world? Has Snowden planted bombs that killed [people?]. . . What crimes has he committed against humanity?"[11]

A petition started on the White House's We the People website gathered more than 100,000 signatures within two weeks after its creation on June 9, 2013. The petition stated: "Edward Snowden is a national hero and should be immediately issued a full, free, and absolute pardon for any crimes he has committed or may have committed related to blowing the whistle on secret NSA surveillance programs." The Obama administration committed to review and respond to any petition that reached more than 100,000 signatures.[12] The White House finally responded in July 2015, not with a pardon but with a call for Snowden to return and face the consequences of his actions. Wrote Lisa Monaco, White House adviser on homeland security and counterterrorism: "He should come home to the United

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